

TYPE OF BUSINESS	NUMBER OF BUSINESSES	AVERAGE NET INCOME (\$'000'S)	RANK ACCORDING TO AVERAGE NET INCOME	PERCENT WITH NET INCOME	AVERAGE RETURN ON RECEIPTS	AVERAGE RECEIPTS REQUIRED TO GENERATE AVERAGE NET INCOME (\$'000'S)	AVERAGE RECEIPTS REQUIRED TO GENERATE THE AVERAGE NET OF COAL MINING (\$'000'S)
Coal Mining	76	196.6	1	34.2	8.2	2,397.6	2,397.6
Offices of Physicians	192,545	87.0	2	87.2	56.2	154.8	349.8
Offices of Osteopathic Physicians	10,598	77.6	3	96.3	57.8	134.3	340.1
Offices of Dentists	96,746	73.1	4	94.9	34.2	201.9	543.1
Offices of Optometrists	12,576	60.1	5	96.1	30.7	195.8	640.4
Bowling Centers	1,547	57.4	6	91.3	31.0	185.2	634.2
Offices of Chiropractors	32,501	47.5	7	85.1	39.3	120.9	500.3
Drug Stores	8,324	45.5	8	82.2	8.7	523.0	2,259.8
Veterinarian Services	19,622	41.7	9	92.5	22.5	185.3	873.8
Legal Services	280,946	39.8	10	86.6	47.4	84.0	414.8

¹Net income was computed from the IRS's federal income tax data for 1992. At that time, there were more than 15 million sole proprietorships in 171 classifications in the U.S.

Their children will have it better. They will not have to take significant risks. They will be well educated. They will become physicians, attorneys, and accountants. Their capital is their intellect. But unlike their parents, they will postpone entering the job market until they are in their late twenties or even their early thirties. And most likely they will adopt an upper-middle-class lifestyle as soon as they start working, a much different lifestyle than their frugal parents had when they started their businesses.